

AUTOMOTIVE COMMERCE & MARKETPLACE PLATFORM

Project Scope, Customer Journeys & Delivery Plan

A single website combining an owner-managed automotive store with a customer-to-customer vehicle marketplace.

Prepared for project planning and implementation

Core idea

Customers can buy products directly from the business, while registered customers can also publish their own vehicle listings and connect with interested buyers through chat or phone. Store payments are handled manually through bank transfer and WhatsApp proof.

Business Store ATF oil, CVT oil, used parts, used cars, damaged cars, and future automotive products.	Customer Marketplace Registered users can publish vehicles for sale in a classifieds-style marketplace.
Manual Payments Checkout shows bank details and WhatsApp instructions. The admin team verifies payment manually.	Two Dashboards A customer dashboard for purchases/listings and a super-admin dashboard for full business control.

Project at a Glance

What the platform is, who uses it, and how the two selling models work together.

The platform will be the main online storefront for the automotive business. It will allow the business team to publish and sell its own stock, accept orders, confirm manual payments, manage delivery, and keep customers informed throughout the order journey.

Alongside the business store, the same website will include a customer marketplace. Registered users will be able to create vehicle advertisements, upload photos, publish details, receive enquiries, chat with interested buyers, and optionally display their phone number.

Visitor / Buyer Browses products and vehicles, searches and filters, adds business products to cart, checks out, contacts marketplace sellers, and creates an account when needed.	Registered Customer / Seller Tracks store orders, saves items, receives notifications, creates and manages vehicle listings, and handles buyer conversations.
Super Admin Team Controls products, stock, orders, payment verification, deliveries, customer accounts, public content, marketplace moderation, settings, and staff access.	One Connected Experience The public website, customer dashboard, and super-admin dashboard will share the same brand, information, and status updates so the experience feels consistent.

Two different transaction models

Business-owned products

These use the normal shopping flow: product -> cart -> checkout -> bank-transfer instructions -> payment verification -> delivery.

Customer-owned vehicle listings

These work like a classifieds marketplace: listing -> view details -> chat/show number -> buyer and seller communicate directly. The platform does not process payment between marketplace users in the first release.

Public Website & Page Structure

The customer-facing website will cover shopping, marketplace discovery, support, account access, and required legal/information pages.

Page	Purpose
Home	Main landing page with automotive promotions, categories, business products, customer vehicle listings, popular items, trust sections, FAQs and strong calls to action.
Shop	Complete business product catalogue with sorting and filters.
Category Pages	Dedicated browsing for ATF Oil, CVT Oil, Used Parts, Used Cars, Damaged Cars, and future categories.
Product Details	Photos, price, condition, stock, specifications, compatibility, description, delivery information, related products and Add to Cart.
Search Results	Combined search experience that can clearly separate business products from customer vehicle listings.
Cart	Items, quantities, totals, remove/update actions, and checkout button.
Checkout	Customer details, address, order summary, delivery choice, account creation option and manual payment method.
Order Confirmation	Order number, next steps, bank-transfer instructions, WhatsApp payment-proof button and expected status flow.
Order Tracking	Simple order-status view for logged-in customers; guest orders can be linked after account creation.
Customer Vehicle Marketplace	Browse customer-posted cars with automotive filters, location, price and condition.
Vehicle Listing Details	Large photo gallery, price, specifications, seller information, location, chat, show-number action, save and report.
Seller Profile / Other Listings	Public view of a seller's active vehicle listings and basic member information.
Sell Your Car	Guided listing flow for creating a vehicle advertisement.

Page	Purpose
About	Business story, value, service approach and trust information.
Contact	Contact form, phone, WhatsApp, email, address/map if required, and support hours.
FAQs	Store ordering, payment, delivery, returns, accounts, listings, chat and marketplace questions.
Shipping & Delivery	Delivery coverage, estimated timeframes, charges and order tracking guidance.
Returns / Refund Policy	Rules for applicable business-owned items and how customers request support.
Marketplace Rules	What users may list, prohibited content, safe trading guidance and moderation rules.
Privacy Policy	How account, order, listing and communication information is handled.
Terms & Conditions	Website, store and marketplace terms.
404 / Empty States	Helpful screens when a page, product, search result, order or listing is unavailable.

Home Page Experience

The home page will be the main discovery area for both the business store and the customer marketplace.

The visual direction will use a premium automotive adaptation of the selected reference website: strong product imagery, animated promotional areas, responsive product sections, category discovery, and clear calls to shop or sell.

Announcement & Header Contact details, search, account, wishlist, cart, navigation, category access and a clear Sell Your Car action.	Hero Slider Large automotive campaigns for oils, parts, used cars or seasonal offers with animated text and calls to action.
Shop by Category Fast entry into ATF Oil, CVT Oil, Used Parts, Used Cars, Damaged Cars and future categories.	Featured Store Products Business-owned products with image, condition, price, discount where relevant, quick actions and Add to Cart.
Customer Cars for Sale A dedicated marketplace section showing recently approved or featured customer listings.	Popular / Recommended Tabs for featured, popular, new arrivals or best-selling store items.
Automotive Promotions Banner sections for special offers, clearance, newly arrived used parts, oils and vehicle stock.	Popular Makes / Vehicle Types Optional discovery by vehicle make, body type or category where useful.
Trust & Service Clear explanation of manual payment, delivery support, verified business inventory and customer service.	Testimonials / Social Proof Optional customer reviews and service feedback managed by the admin.
FAQs Expandable answers to the most common questions.	Latest Updates Optional articles or automotive guides if content publishing is enabled later.

Important visual behavior

The home page will be fully responsive and will preserve the reference site's overall layout rhythm, sliders, tabs, card hovers, scrolling sections, counters/countdowns where used, accordions, dropdowns and mobile navigation behavior - but with original automotive content and imagery.

Business Store: Products, Parts, Oils & Vehicles

The business can sell multiple automotive product types while keeping product information clear and easy to compare.

Product catalogue information

Core Information Product name, category, brand, part number/SKU, price, sale price, condition, stock and images.	Vehicle Compatibility Compatible makes, models, years and other fitment notes for parts where applicable.
Oil / Fluid Details Oil type, grade/specification, volume/pack size, suitable vehicles and usage notes.	Used Part Details Condition, donor vehicle details where useful, visible wear notes, included pieces and compatibility.
Business Vehicle Details Make, model, year, mileage, transmission, fuel type, engine, condition, city, registration information, photos and description.	Delivery & Support Availability, delivery notes, estimated handling time, return eligibility and support contact.

Shopping controls

- Search by product name, part number, category, vehicle make/model or other useful keywords.
- Filter by category, price, brand, condition, availability, compatible vehicle, year and other category-specific values.
- Sort by newest, price, popularity or featured status.
- Save items to a wishlist for later.
- Add eligible business products to cart and adjust quantities before checkout.
- For high-value vehicles, the admin can choose whether a listing uses Add to Cart or a Contact for Purchase style action.
- Related and recommended products can be shown on product pages to improve discovery.

Store Order & Manual Payment Journey

There is no online card/payment gateway in the first release. The payment flow is designed around bank transfer and WhatsApp proof.

1	2	3	4	5	6
Select	Cart	Checkout	Order	Pay	Verify
Customer chooses a business product.	Reviews items and totals.	Enters delivery details.	Receives order number.	Transfers to bank account.	Admin confirms payment.

What happens at checkout

- The customer provides name, email, phone number and delivery address.
- If the customer is not signed in, they can create an account during checkout so the order appears in their dashboard.
- The final screen clearly shows the business bank information, amount due and a unique order number/reference.
- A WhatsApp button opens the correct business number with a pre-filled message containing the order reference. The customer sends the payment screenshot in WhatsApp.
- The order enters a Pending Payment / Payment Verification status until the admin team confirms it.

Admin verification and fulfilment

1	2	3	4	5	6
Pending Payment	Proof Checked	Paid	Preparing	Shipped	Delivered
Order created and visible to admins.	Team checks WhatsApp screenshot and amount.	Admin marks payment verified.	Order is packed / prepared.	Courier/tracking details can be added.	Customer receives final confirmation.

If payment is unclear

The admin can mark the payment as Needs Attention / Not Verified and send the customer a clear email update asking them to contact support or resend proof.

Customer Vehicle Marketplace

Registered customers can create vehicle advertisements in a classifieds-style experience similar in purpose to OLX, while the business retains moderation control.

Marketplace browsing

Vehicle Feed Grid/list views with strong images, price, location, make/model, year and posting time.	Search & Filters Make, model, year, price, mileage, condition, city/location, transmission, fuel type, body type and seller type if needed.
Featured & Recent Admins can choose which approved listings appear on the home page or marketplace highlights.	Save & Share Customers can save listings to favorites and share a listing link.

Vehicle listing page

- Large image gallery with multiple photos.
- Price, title, city/location, posting date and listing status.
- Make, model, year, mileage, transmission, fuel type, engine, body type, color, registration status and overall condition.
- Detailed seller description plus damage/repair notes where relevant.
- Seller card showing member information and other active listings.
- Chat button for an in-platform conversation.
- Show Number button where the seller allows phone contact.
- Save/Favorite, Share and Report Listing actions.
- Similar listings for continued browsing.

Marketplace payment model

The platform helps buyers and sellers discover each other and communicate. In the first release, it does not collect payment for customer-to-customer vehicle deals.

Sell Your Car: Listing Creation Flow

The selling process will be guided, easy to complete on mobile, and designed to collect enough detail for a useful vehicle advertisement.

1	2	3	4	5	6
Vehicle	Condition	Photos	Price	Contact	Preview
Make, model, year and core vehicle details.	Mileage, condition, damage and ownership details.	Upload clear exterior/interior images.	Set asking price and location.	Choose chat and phone visibility.	Review and submit for approval.

Suggested listing fields

Vehicle Make, model, variant/trim, year, body type, fuel, transmission and engine.	Condition Mileage, overall condition, accident/damage notes, registration status and color.
Sale Information Title, asking price, city/location and detailed description.	Media Multiple vehicle photos with a chosen cover image.
Contact Preferences Allow chat, show/hide phone number and preferred contact method.	Preview & Submission Customer confirms how the public listing will look before submission.

Listing statuses

- Draft - saved but not submitted.
- Pending Review - waiting for admin moderation.
- Approved / Live - visible publicly.
- Rejected / Changes Required - customer sees the reason and can edit/resubmit.
- Paused - temporarily hidden by the seller or admin.
- Sold - seller marks the vehicle as sold.
- Expired - optional future rule if listings have a validity period.

Accounts, Sign-In & Customer Dashboard

Customers can use a normal account or supported single sign-on. The account area brings shopping and marketplace activity into one place.

Account access pages

Sign In Email/phone and password, remember-me option, social sign-in buttons and clear links for recovery.	Create Account Name, email/phone, password, agreement to terms, and social sign-in options.
Verify Account Email verification flow where required.	Forgot / Reset Password Recovery request and new-password screens.

Customer dashboard sections

Section	What the customer can do
Overview	Recent orders, order statuses, listing activity, unread messages, favorites and recent notifications.
My Orders	All business-store orders with status, totals and dates.
Order Details	Items, address, payment state, bank-transfer instructions, delivery progress, tracking information and support contact.
My Listings	Draft, pending, live, paused, sold and rejected vehicle listings.
Create / Edit Listing	Full guided vehicle listing form with preview.
Messages	Buyer/seller conversations linked to individual vehicle listings.
Favorites	Saved business products and marketplace vehicle listings.
Notifications	Order, payment, delivery, listing approval and chat alerts.
Profile	Name, phone, email and profile details.
Addresses	Saved delivery addresses.
Security	Password update, connected sign-in methods and account security controls.

Super Admin Dashboard: Business Control

The super-admin area is the operating centre for the store, customer marketplace, content, communication and staff workflow.

Dashboard overview

Today's Activity New orders, pending payments, paid orders, deliveries, new customers and new marketplace listings.	Action Required Payments waiting for verification, low-stock items, listings waiting for approval and customer issues.
Sales Snapshot Order value, top products/categories and simple period comparisons.	Marketplace Snapshot Active listings, pending approvals, reported listings and recent seller activity.

Orders & manual payments

- View all orders and filter by payment, fulfilment, delivery or date status.
- Open a complete order record with customer, items, amount, address, notes and status history.
- Mark bank payment as Verified, Not Verified or Needs Attention after checking WhatsApp proof.
- Add internal notes so admin team members know what has already been checked.
- Move orders through Preparing, Shipped, Out for Delivery, Delivered, Cancelled or other agreed statuses.
- Add courier name and tracking/reference information when available.
- Resend key customer email updates where needed.

Admin notifications

The dashboard will prominently surface items that need action so the team does not have to search manually for pending payments, orders or marketplace approvals.

Super Admin Dashboard: Catalog, Marketplace & Website Content

The business team will be able to update day-to-day website content without changing code.

Products Create, edit, archive and feature business-owned products and vehicles.	Categories Manage ATF Oil, CVT Oil, Used Parts, Used Cars, Damaged Cars and future categories/subcategories.
Inventory Stock levels, low-stock warnings, availability and status management.	Brands / Compatibility Manage brands and structured compatibility options used by automotive filters.
Customers View customer accounts, order history, listing activity, status and support notes.	Marketplace Listings Review new submissions, approve/reject, request changes, pause, remove or feature listings.
Reports & Flags Review customer reports against marketplace listings and take moderation action.	Home Page Content Manage hero slides, category blocks, featured products, marketplace highlights, promotional banners, FAQs and testimonials.
Site Pages Edit the main information pages such as About, Delivery, Returns, Terms, Privacy and Marketplace Rules.	Media Library Reuse uploaded product, vehicle, banner and content images.
Promotions Set featured items, sale labels, campaign banners and home-page promotional positions.	Notifications Manage customer-facing email wording for important order and marketplace events.
Payment Settings Bank account details, account holder name, WhatsApp payment number and checkout instructions.	Delivery Settings Delivery areas, charges, free-delivery rules, courier options and guidance text.
Admin Team Add team members and control which dashboard areas they can access.	Activity History Record important admin actions such as order status changes, payment verification and listing moderation.

Notifications, Email & Communication

Customers and admins should always know when something important changes.

Customer email events

Account Welcome/verification, password reset and important account changes.	Orders Order placed, payment instructions, payment verified/not verified, preparing, shipped, out for delivery, delivered and cancelled.
Marketplace Listing submitted, approved, rejected/changes required, paused/removed and optional expiry reminders.	Messages Optional missed-message email when a marketplace conversation has not been seen.

In-app notifications

- Customers see new order, payment, delivery, listing and chat notifications inside their dashboard.
- Admins see pending payment, new order, low stock, new listing, report and other action-required notifications.
- Unread counts are visible in the relevant navigation areas so important items are easy to find.

Buyer-seller chat

- Each conversation is attached to a specific marketplace vehicle listing.
- Buyers and sellers can exchange text messages inside their account area.
- Unread indicators help both sides see new messages.
- Users can report inappropriate listings or communication, and admins can investigate marketplace reports.
- Phone numbers can be shown only when the seller has chosen to make them visible.

Search, Filters, Trust & Automotive Usability

The website should help customers quickly narrow down the correct part, oil or vehicle while keeping marketplace content manageable.

Store search and filtering

- Category, brand, price and condition.
- In-stock / available status.
- Vehicle make, model and year for compatible parts.
- Part number / SKU where relevant.
- Oil/fluid grade or pack size where relevant.
- Business vehicles can use vehicle-specific filters such as year, mileage, transmission, fuel and condition.

Marketplace search and filtering

- Make, model, year range, price range and mileage.
- City/location, condition, transmission, fuel type and body type.
- Keyword search and sorting by newest or price.

Trust and moderation

Admin Approval New customer vehicle listings can require approval before appearing publicly.	Report Listing Visitors can report suspicious, incorrect or inappropriate marketplace content.
Clear Ownership Store products and customer marketplace listings are visually labelled differently.	Seller Controls Customers can edit, pause, mark sold or remove their own listings.
Safe-Trading Guidance Marketplace pages can show reminders that buyer/seller transactions happen directly.	Business Support Store purchases always lead back to the business support/contact information.

Responsive Experience & Important Scenarios

The complete experience will be designed for desktop, tablet and mobile, with all major states represented rather than only ideal screens.

Responsive behavior

- Mobile-first navigation with a clean category/menu drawer.
- Product and vehicle grids that adapt from one column to multiple columns.
- Forms designed for touch input, especially the Sell Your Car flow and checkout.
- Sticky or easy-to-reach actions where appropriate on small screens.
- Image galleries, sliders and tables simplified appropriately for mobile.
- Dashboards that remain usable on smaller screens through responsive sidebars/drawers and stacked cards.

States that will be planned

Loading Skeletons or placeholders while content is being prepared.	Empty No cart items, no orders, no listings, no messages, no favorites, no search results.
Success Order placed, listing submitted, profile saved, payment verified and other completed actions.	Error Invalid form values, unavailable item, failed image upload, expired link or unavailable page.
Permission Signed-out user trying to sell/chat, customer trying to access admin-only pages, etc.	Offline / Retry Clear retry guidance for temporary connection issues where appropriate.

How We Will Build It

The project will be delivered in connected stages so the public website, customer marketplace and admin operations are designed as one system.

1. Experience planning - confirm brand content, categories, manual payment details, delivery rules, marketplace moderation rules and customer communication needs.
2. Visual system and responsive layouts - establish the automotive theme, typography, reusable page patterns, mobile behavior and dashboard layout.
3. Public website and business store - build the home page, catalog, category pages, product pages, search, cart and support/information pages.
4. Checkout and manual payment flow - build order creation, bank-transfer instructions, WhatsApp payment-proof guidance and customer order statuses.
5. Accounts and customer dashboard - add sign-in, account creation, social sign-in, profile, orders, favorites, notifications and settings.
6. Customer vehicle marketplace - build marketplace browsing, vehicle details, Sell Your Car flow, seller controls, favorites, chat and moderation states.
7. Super-admin dashboard - add order/payment management, catalog, stock, customers, marketplace approvals, page content, settings, notifications and admin team access.
8. Communication and status updates - connect customer/admin notifications and transactional emails to the major order and marketplace events.
9. Quality assurance - test responsive layouts, complete customer journeys, edge cases, form validation, permissions and important browser/device sizes.
10. Cloud launch and handover - deploy the production website, connect the domain and security certificate, configure storage/email/monitoring, prepare backups, and provide operational handover.

Design principle

The customer should never need to understand the internal system. Every screen will focus on the next useful action: shop, pay, track, sell, approve, verify, deliver or communicate.

First-Release Scope & Future Readiness

Keeping the first release focused makes operations clear while leaving room for later growth.

Included in the first release

- Responsive public website and automotive store.
- Business product catalogue, cart and checkout.
- Manual bank-transfer payment instructions and admin verification.
- Customer accounts and customer dashboard.
- Customer vehicle marketplace with listing creation and moderation.
- Buyer/seller chat and optional phone-number reveal.
- Favorites, search and filtering.
- Super-admin dashboard for daily business operations and public content control.
- Order and delivery status management.
- Customer and admin notifications plus transactional email.
- Cloud hosting, media storage, monitoring and backups.

Not part of the first release unless added later

- Online card/wallet payment gateway.
- Platform-held payments or escrow for customer-to-customer vehicle sales.
- Native iPhone/Android applications.
- Automatic vehicle inspection or ownership verification services.
- Automatic courier booking/tracking integrations with third-party logistics providers.
- Paid marketplace listing plans, commissions or subscription billing.

Future additions the structure can support

- Online payment gateway and refunds.
- Paid featured marketplace listings.
- Vehicle dealer accounts and seller packages.
- Delivery/courier integrations.
- Advanced business analytics and financial reports.
- Mobile applications using the same business data.
- Vehicle inspection, financing or warranty partner integrations.

Technology Used

The implementation will use a modern, maintainable web stack. These tools are listed for transparency; customers will only experience the finished website.

Next.js Main web application framework for the public site and dashboards.	TypeScript Keeps the application code safer and easier to maintain as the project grows.
Tailwind CSS Responsive styling system for the website and dashboards.	shadcn/ui High-quality reusable interface components for forms, dialogs, tables and dashboards.
TanStack Query Reliable loading and refreshing of website and dashboard information.	React Hook Form + Zod Consistent forms and validation for checkout, accounts, products and vehicle listings.
Auth.js Account sign-in, session handling and supported social/single sign-on options.	PostgreSQL Main database for products, customers, orders, listings, messages and settings.
Prisma Application data management layer for the PostgreSQL database.	Pusher Real-time chat and live notification updates between marketplace users where required.
Framer Motion Smooth interface animations and page interactions that match the chosen visual direction.	

Single sign-on

The account screens can include supported providers such as Google and Apple, depending on the final accounts/configuration available for launch.

Hosting, Storage & Database

The production setup will be kept simple: the website and PostgreSQL database will run on AWS EC2, while uploaded images and media will be stored on Amazon S3.

AWS EC2 Runs the website/application and the PostgreSQL database on the same cloud server.	Amazon S3 Stores product images, vehicle listing photos and other uploaded media.
PostgreSQL The main database for products, customers, orders, listings, messages and settings. It will run directly on the AWS EC2 server.	

Operational readiness

- Production and development environments will be kept separate.
- Uploaded media will be stored on Amazon S3 instead of inside the main application files.
- HTTPS will be enabled for customer and admin access.
- Admin access will be protected through authenticated accounts and role permissions.
- Email notifications will be configured for important account, order, payment and delivery updates.

Items to Confirm Before Final Launch

These details do not block the overall structure, but they should be confirmed before production content and operations are finalized.

Brand Final website name, logo, colors, typography preferences and contact details.	Market Primary country/cities, currency and delivery coverage.
Bank Payment Bank name, account title, account number/IBAN, payment instructions and WhatsApp number.	Delivery Delivery charges, free-delivery thresholds, estimated timeframes and courier process.
Returns Which product categories are returnable and the business's final return/refund rules.	Marketplace Moderation Whether every customer listing requires approval, prohibited listing rules and report-handling process.
Phone Visibility Whether seller phone numbers are visible by default or only after the seller chooses to show them.	Social Sign-In Final SSO providers such as Google and Apple.
Admin Team How many team members need dashboard access and what responsibilities should be separated.	Content Initial product inventory, category names, photos, policy text, FAQs, testimonials and promotional banners.

Result

Once these business details are supplied, the platform can move from a complete functional build into final branded production content and launch configuration.

END OF PROJECT SCOPE